CASE STUDY (UPI FRAUD) –

UPI fraud is a common cybercrime in India where scammers trick users into sending money through fake payment requests. In a typical case, a fraudster calls or messages a victim pretending to be a bank official or seller. They send a “collect request” on UPI apps like Google Pay or PhonePe and ask the victim to approve it, claiming it is required to receive money.

Many users do not realize that approving such requests actually sends money instead of receiving it. Students and elderly people are often targeted because they may not fully understand how digital payments work.

The consequences include financial loss, stress, and difficulty recovering the money. In some cases, victims lose large amounts within minutes.

This crime highlights the importance of awareness and careful online behaviour. Users must always verify requests and never share OTPs or personal details.